

Graphics cards

Graphics cards are one hotly contested category and this year was no exception. We tested more cards this year, than we have ever done and one thing's for sure — there's no dearth of choice!

Entry-level up to Rs. 5,000 Galaxy GeForce 8400 GS

A half-height card, a price tag of Rs. 1,500 based on current market prices and a set of full height and half height brackets supplied all mean that the Galaxy 8400 GS is unbeatable for sheer value. It'll play Blu-Ray 1080p content easily and you can play the occasional game as well.

Entry-level between Rs. 5,000 to 7,000 ZOTAC GeForce 9600GT Eco

ZOTAC's GeForce 9600GT Eco is a very good option priced at just over Rs. 5,000. The fact that it makes do without any additional power, other than what is available from the PCI

Express slot is enough to win many hearts, particularly those who demand performance but don't have a very good power supply. A well deserved Zero 1 Award for ZOTAC.

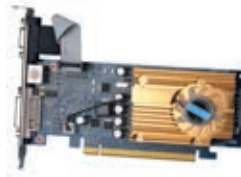
Mid-range up to Rs. 10,000 Galaxy GTS 250 and Sapphire Radeon HD 4850

Both these cards are equally impressive and there's a hairsbreadth between them, meaning you can choose either and not worry about making a mistake. There's a lot of performance available for this price range and we reckon anyone who can shell out around Rs. 7,000, can have a sweet gaming solution in either one of these winners. The fact that some other cards, based on the same GPU, cost over Rs. 10,000, is testament enough to the value factor.



High-end up to Rs. 17,500 ZOTAC GTX 260² and Palit GTX 260 216 SONIC

For their price, these cards simply deliver the goods. The fact that you can buy a high-end card for under Rs. 14,000 is simply amazing news for most cash-deprived gamers. Definite Zero 1 material.



Best Performer ZOTAC GTX 295

ZOTAC's GTX 295 remains the fastest, most powerful graphics card we tested this year. It's a little unfair to compare it to the ATi Radeon HD 5870-based cards, simply because this is a dual GPU solution and if you're looking for future proofing and something that doesn't consume a lot of power and generate a lot of heat, the Radeon 5870 is right up your alley. However, the fact remains, that the ZOTAC GTX 295 is the fastest thing your money can buy...for the moment. It's priced at Rs. 30,500, but expect that to drop into the high twenties.



High-end-above Rs. 24,500 Sapphire Radeon HD 5870

The shiny newcomer from ATi's stables in all its 40nm glory walks away with the trophy. 26,000 bucks is a lot of dough to cough up on a graphics card, but hardcore gamers who demand nothing but the best will not feel let down. DX 11 support, good thermal specifications and great performance all through are its forte. A shiny Zero 1 award to the bold newcomer.

